

Project 3 (C++): Given a connected undirected graph, $G=\langle N, E \rangle$, using the Prim's algorithm to construct the Minimum Spanning Tree (MST) of G . (Not a hard project, you are given 3 and ½ day to implement it.)

Prim's algorithm uses two sets, setA and setB to construct an MST of G . Initially, setA contains only one node (can be any node in G and setB contains the rest of nodes.

You will be given 2 data files: data1 and data2; data1 is a small graph, and data2 is a larger graph.

What you need to do as follows:

- 1) Use a blank paper, draw the graph for data1 on the top of the page. Then draw the sequence of boxes for SetA and SetB with 3 as the initial node in SetA, using Prim's algorithm to find the MST as illustrated in class.
- 2) Implement your program based on the specs given below.
- 3) Run and debug your program with data1 (using 3 as the initial node in setA and the rest in setB) until your program produces the same MST as in your illustration.
- 4) Run your program 6 times with data2 using 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11 as the initial node in setA.

****Include in your hard copy:**

- cover page with algorithm steps.
- hand drawn illustration of 1) in the above. -2 if omitted.
- source code.
- outFile1 and MSTFile with data1 using 3 as initial SetA.
- outFile1 and MSTFile with data2 using 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, and 11 the initial node in setA.

Language: C++

Project name: Prim's Minimum Spending Tree algorithm

Project points: 10pts

Due Date: Soft copy and hard copies:

10/10 (on time): 3/1/2026 Monday before midnight (11:59pm).

-10/10 (non-submission): 3/1/2026 Monday after midnight.

***** All submission MUST include Soft copy (*.zip) and hard copy (*.docx) in the same email attachments with correct email subject as stated in the project submission requirement; otherwise, your submission will be rejected.**

Email subject: (323) first name last name <Project 3: Prim's Minimum Spending Tree algorithm (C++)>

***** Inside the email body includes:**

- Your answer to the five questions (-2 if omitted)
- Screen recoding link. (-2 without the recording!)

***** Place your screen recording link in your project submission email body below the 5 questions.**

I. Inputs: There are two inputs to the program

a) inFile (argv [1]): A text file contains a connected undirected graph, as a list of edges with costs, $\langle n_i, n_j, cost \rangle$.

The first text line in the file is the number of nodes in G , follows by a list of triplets, $\langle n_i, n_j, cost \rangle$

For example:

5 // there are 5 nodes in the graph

1 5 10 // an undirected edge: i.e., an edge $\langle 1, 5, 10 \rangle$ and an edge $\langle 5, 1, 10 \rangle$

2 3 5 // an undirected edge: i.e., an edge $\langle 2, 3, 5 \rangle$ and an edge $\langle 3, 2, 5 \rangle$

1 2 20

3 5 2

:

:

b) nodeInSetA (argv [2]) // user select a node to be in setA.

II. Output:

a) MSTfile (argv [3]): The result of Prim's MST in text file in the following format:

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** There are 5 nodes in the input graph
** Initial node in SetA =
** Edges in MST are given below
    2 3 5 // an edge <2, 3, 5>
    3 5 2
    :
** The total cost =
=====
```

b) outFile1 (argv [4]): as program dictates

III. Data structure:

- An uEdge class

- (int) Ni // node ID.
- (int) Nj // node ID.
- (int) cost // the cost of the edge <Ni, Nj>.
- (uEdge *) next

Methods:

- constructor (...) // to create a new uEdge node with (Ni, Nj, cost, null)
- printEdge (edge, outFile1) // print the given edge info to outFile1 in the following format.
<edge's Ni, edge's Nj, edge's cost, edge's next>

- A PrimMST class

- (int) numNodes //number of nodes in G.
- (int) nodeInSetA // get from argv [2]
- (char *) whichSet // a 1-D char array, size of numNodes +1, dynamically allocated.
// to indicate which set each node belongs to ('A' for setA or 'B' for setB)
- (uEdge *) edgeListHead // The list head of a sorted linked list of uEdge of the input graph edges
//in ascending order w.r.t. cost; so that to find a min cost edge would be simple,
// i.e., at the front of the list, as long as the two nodes in the edge are not in the same set.
// Initially, it points to a dummy node <0, 0, 0, null> when created.
- (uEdge *) MSTlistHead // The list head of an un-sorted linked list of uEdge nodes in Prim's MST.
// Initially, it points to a dummy node <0, 0, 0, null>
- (int) totalMSTCost // initially set to zero

Methods:

- (uEdge) findSpot (edgeListHead, newEdge) // find the spot where newEdge to be inserted after Spot. Search key
// is cost, in ascending order; similar to findspot (...) in your project 2.
- insertOneNode (Spot, newEdge) // insert newEdge between Spot and Spot.next.
// newEdge-> next ← Spot->next
// Spot-> next ← newEdge.
- (uEdge) removeEdge (...) // The method searches edge nodes in edgeListHead list, if list is not empty,
// finds the first edge, e: <Ni, Nj, cost> where Ni and Nj are NOT in the same set
// i.e., whichSet[e.Ni] != whichSet[e.Nj] **and** one of Ni or Nj is in SetA, i.e.,
// either whichSet[e->Ni] == 'A' or whichSet[e->Nj] == 'A'.
// Then, remove edge node <Ni, Nj, cost> from the edge list and returns e.
// **On your own.**
- updateMST (...) // **See algorithm below.**
- pushEdgeToMST (...) // push edge on the top of MSTlistHead after dummy. //stack operation. **On your own.**

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- printSet (...) // print the whichSet array to outFile1, in two text-lines with index on the top
  // and whichSet[i] on the second text-line; for example
    1  2  3  4  5
    A  B  A  B  A
- printEdgeList (...) // print edges in edgeListHead to outFile1 with the following format:
    // edgelistHead → <0, 0, 0, Ni1> → <Ni1, Nj1, edgeCost, Ni2> → <Ni2, Nj2, edgeCost, Ni3> ...
- printMSTList (...) // print nodes in the list point by MSTlistHead to outFile1 with the following
  // MSTlistHead → <0, 0, 0, Ni1> → <Ni1, Nj1, edgeCost, Ni2> → <Ni2, Nj2, edgeCost, Ni3> ...
- printMST (...) // print the final MST to MSTfile in the format given in the above, under section II, MSTfile.
- (bool) isDone (...) // returns true if whichSet are all 'A', otherwise returns false.
- updateMST (newEdge) // see algorithm below.

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IV. main (...)

Step 0: inFile, outFile1, MSTfile ← open via argv[]

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numNodes ← get from inFile
nodeInSetA ← get from argv [2]
whichSet [] ← dynamically allocated, size of numNodes+1, and initialize all to set 'B'
whichSet [0] ← 'A' // although we do not use index 0.
whichSet[nodeInSetA] ← 'A' // now, setA has only one node, nodeInSetA.
printSet (whichSet, outFile1) // with caption.
edgelistHead ← get an uEdge as the dummy node <0, 0, 0, null> for it to point to.
MSTlistHead ← get an uEdge as the dummy node <0, 0, 0, null> for it to point to.
totalMSTCost ← 0

```

// Step 1 to Step 3 are constructing the linked list of edges in ascending order with respect to edge costs.

Step 1: Ni ← read from inFile.

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Nj ← read from inFile.
edgeCost ← read from inFile.
newEdge ← create a new uEdge node with (Ni, Nj, edgeCost, null)
Spot ← findSpot (edgelistHead, newEdge)
insertOneNode (Spot, newEdge)

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Step 2: outFile1 ← "In main () print the list of edges"

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printEdgeList (edgelistHead, outFile1)

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Step 3: repeat step 1 to step 2 until the inFile is empty.

// Step 4 to Step 9 are constructing MST, need not be sorted.

Step 4: e ← removeEdge (edgelistHead)

Step 5: printEdge (e, outFile1) // with caption: "***The removed edge is:" // print edge e.

Step 6: updateMST (MSTlistHead, e)

Step 7: printSet (whichSet, outFile1) // with caption: "*** Below shows nodes in whichSet ***"

Step 8: printEdgeList (edgeListHead, outFile1) // with caption: "*** Below is the sorted edge list ***"

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printMSTList (MSTlistHead, outFile1) // with caption: "Below is the intermediate constructed MST list ***"

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Step 9: repeat step 4 – step 8 until isDone (whichSet)

Step 10: printMST (MSTlistHead, MSTfile)

Step 11: close all files.

V. updateMST (MSTlistHead, edge)

Step 1: pushEdgeToMST (MSTlistHead, edge)

Step 2: totalMSTCost += edge.cost

Step 3: if whichSet [edge.Ni] == 'A' // Ni is in setA,

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    whichSet [edge.Nj] ← 'A' // re-assign Nj from setB to setA

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else

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    whichSet [edge.Ni] ← 'A' // re-assign Ni from setB to setA

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